

### 3. "The Road That Changed Everything"

*(Inspired by Luke 10:25-37 — ~6-7 minutes)*

The road from Jerusalem to Jericho was dangerous—steep, winding, and known for thieves. Everyone knew that. Which is why the man traveling alone kept his head down and his pace quick.

It wasn't enough.

They came without warning. Hands. Fists. Boots. The world narrowed to pain and dust and darkness. When they left, they took everything—his money, his dignity, his hope.

He lay there, barely breathing.

Footsteps approached. A priest.

Relief stirred weakly in the man's chest. Surely this one would help. But the footsteps slowed... then shifted. The priest crossed to the other side of the road and passed by.

Later, another figure came—a Levite. Another flicker of hope. Another pause. Another choice made. He too walked away.

Time stretched. The sun burned. Pain throbbed.

Then—someone else.

A Samaritan.

If the man had strength, he might have laughed bitterly. Samaritans were despised. Outsiders. Enemies.

But this one stopped.

He knelt. He saw the blood, the brokenness, the risk. And instead of calculating the cost, he chose compassion.

He cleaned the wounds. He lifted the man onto his own animal. Every step toward the inn was an act of mercy. Every coin he paid was given without promise of return.

As the Samaritan left the next morning, he spoke softly to the innkeeper. "Take care of him. If it costs more, I'll pay when I return."

Jesus finished the story and looked at the crowd. "Which of these was a neighbor?"

The answer was uncomfortable, undeniable.

"The one who showed mercy."

Jesus nodded. "Go—and do likewise."

Because love is not proven by position, or knowledge, or title. Love is proven on the road—when compassion costs something, and mercy refuses to look away.